



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

COMMERCIAL & CONSTRUCTION RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection Agency for Businesses

Recovering unpaid progress billings, retainage and change orders for SAECO Electric & Utility Ltd — on pure contingency

Prepared for **SAECO Electric & Utility Ltd** · July 2026

A recovery partner for the money held back on the job

Prepared for SAECO Electric & Utility Ltd — a specialized utility contractor's hardest dollars to collect are the ones held back after the work is in the ground: retainage that sits long past completion, progress billings a general contractor slow-pays, and approved change orders that go unpaid on public and private infrastructure jobs.

Money held back is still money you earned. Retainage, slow-paid pay apps and unpaid change orders tie up the crews, equipment and materials you already put in the ground — and every month past terms erodes leverage.

Southwest Recovery Services is a commercial, B2B-focused collection agency working business receivables on **pure contingency since 2004**, nationwide across all 50 states. Place accounts through a secure portal that takes your AR export, and we work them. No recovery, no fee.

Two decades of commercial recovery — nationwide

A track record built on high-volume B2B receivables and a documented, professional process.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

[USA Today](#) [Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service 2025](#)

[insideARM — 10× ROI](#) [CFO Tech Outlook — Top 10](#) [International Business Times](#)

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



What a utility contractor asks us

The questions that matter for a construction / utility receivables book.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover; the rate scales with the age, balance and volume of your placements. We quote against a representative sample of your accounts.
What we recover	Unpaid progress and milestone billings, held retainage, approved change orders, and final billings — owed by general contractors, developers, and public-agency-funded projects (TXDOT, county and municipal work), plus any past-due B2B balance.
Timing & aging	Recovery falls sharply with age — ~85–90% at 30 days to ~23% at a year. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours of placement; placing retainage and disputed balances promptly after completion recovers materially more than letting them sit.
Disputed accounts & slow-pay GCs	A “pay-when-paid” stall or a disputed change order pauses recovery, it doesn’t end it: we validate against the contract, pay app, change order and lien waiver and work it professionally — and pursue bond and lien rights where available, with your counsel.
Onboarding & placement	Fast and low-lift — bulk-upload an AR / aging export from your accounting system through our portal; we map your columns, so there’s no re-keying.
Compliance & reach	Nationwide across all 50 states from 12 offices in 7 states; documented, professional process; ACA International member; clean record since 2004.

Low-lift intake and full visibility, on demand

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built to take your AR-aging exports and give your team live, self-service access throughout recovery, backed by a dedicated account manager.

SYSTEM-READY PLACEMENT

Bulk-upload an AR / aging export from your accounting system (CSV/Excel) — we map your columns, no re-keying.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — a live dashboard, not a monthly summary.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send contracts, invoices, change orders, pay apps and lien/bond notices safely inside the portal, not over email.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a customer makes directly to you, so balances stay accurate and no one is over-contacted.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Commercial Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's commercial book, anonymized by sector.

INDUSTRIAL EQUIPMENT

MAKER

Filtration & components

\$72K recovered

of ~\$74K placed

97% recovered

FREIGHT & LOGISTICS

CARRIER

Bulk transport

\$279K recovered

of ~\$396K placed

70% recovered

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

FIRM

Legal & advisory

\$212K recovered

of ~\$273K placed

78% recovered

B2B SOFTWARE / SAAS

Recurring-revenue platform

\$129K recovered

of ~\$307K placed

42% recovered

EQUIPMENT & FIELD SERVICES

Rental & service

\$96K recovered

of ~\$467K placed

21% recovered

STAFFING & RECRUITING FIRM

Talent services

\$71K recovered

of ~\$396K placed

18% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE DSO ADVANTAGE**Why fresh balances recover best**

A commercial balance is most collectible while it's fresh; every month it ages, contact data goes stale and leverage erodes.

THE AGE CURVE

Fresh accounts (under ~90 days) often resolve in 30–60 days; balances that sit a year collect a fraction of that.

THE STANDING RULE

A fixed “place at 90 days” policy — including retainage past its release date — recovers materially more, and on contingency there's no cost to placing.

We speak your job ledger

A utility-contractor receivables book has a specific recovery profile — retainage, pay apps and change orders. Our playbook is built for it.



Retainage recovery

Recovering retainage held long past completion — validated against the contract and closeout documents.



Slow-pay GCs & change orders

Documentation-driven recovery on 'pay-when-paid' stalls and disputed but approved change orders.



Bond & lien awareness

Pursuit of payment-bond and lien rights where available on public and private jobs, working with your counsel.



Nationwide reach

Recovery across all 50 states from 12 offices in 7 states.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

“Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.”

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Firm, effective recovery has to stay professional — these are contractors and agencies you'll bid with again. That protects the relationship, protects the

SAECO Electric & Utility Ltd name, and protects you from the liability that sloppy collections create.

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



Capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for SAECO
Electric & Utility Ltd

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The Recovery Waterfall

Our collection process · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data-first recovery · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Aktos Advantage

AI-powered collections · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Cost of Waiting: DSO & Recovery

Aging & recovery · PDF

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Let's turn your held retainage and slow pay apps back into cash.

A 30-minute call to walk your past-due job file — retainage, progress billings and change orders — and put a contingency rate against a representative sample.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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Southwest Recovery Services, LLC · 16200 Addison Road, Suite 260, Addison, TX 75001 · (866) 551-4684
12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for SAECO Electric & Utility Ltd. FDCPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.